



Xbox One back in the game

Microsoft updates Xbox One - removes the always on internet connection requirement and allows game sharing. <http://dgit.in/17ZWodD>



Peace and Harmony

Logitech is planning to launch its Harmony remote service on iOS and Android platform for \$99.99

Industry Connect

Q1 Would it be fair to say that WD is primarily looking at SSHDs? Or do you see WD getting into the pure SSD market in a big way?

Bill Cain: I think our focus is right now on SSHD and thin devices but there are still a lot of applications where the standard hard drive is the right solution. So, we'll continue to deliver those while also working on form factors that enable thin and robust systems. I won't discount the possibility of getting into the pure SSD segment in the future but right now the enterprise space makes the most sense for us to deliver SSD products. But with the evolution of the mobile space, we think getting into pure flash storage in the consumer segment is a possibility.



Richard Rutledge, Sr. VP and GM

Q2 The ideal PC configuration would be to have a 128GB SSD coupled with 500GB or a 1TB hard drive. With 128GB SSDs falling below \$100, is there a possibility of a \$200 SSHD with the same config?

Bill Cain: We haven't announced any such thing so far, but when you start looking at the space where SSHDs can play there is a whole range of products and prices for consumers. Users range from someone with a low-cost PC who just wants a slight performance enhancement with 8GB of flash storage all the way up to a power user who would want the entire OS and all apps residing in solid state storage in a single package that plugs into the system. I see that entire space to be a realm for SSHDs but currently the products we offer to OEMs are more focused on Ultra-book storage which would mean 16 to 32GBs of solid state storage. The two scenarios we talked about definitely do exist, it's just that we haven't announced anything targeting those users yet.

Q3 What type of users is WD focusing on with its products?

Bill Cain: We aren't just focusing on power users since even typical consumers have iPhones with high resolution cameras and they generate a significant amount of content. My mom is 81 years old and she loves digital photography and she stores a tremendous amount of data, something that would be impractical to store in the cloud. So, we are definitely targeting our products at that segment too. We are also looking at mid-sized enterprises with about a dozen or even a hundred users with our SMB solutions. We target the large enterprises through our OEM partners to whom we provide our storage products.

Q4 The 2011 Thailand floods had hard drive prices skyrocketing. Do you know if those prices will ever come down to pre-flood levels? What has WD done to ensure that storage prices remain stable in case of similar events in the future?

Bill Cain: We have made a number of infrastructure improvements to ensure that we aren't affected like that,

again. As part of our ongoing risk management process, we've closely looked at all of the attributes to make sure we can mitigate interruptions from things like earthquakes in the area of a wafer fabrication plant. We are also focused on having a well distributed supply base to make sure that that disruptions don't happen in the future. With respect to pricing, I think currently we've reached a stable, rational environment and we'll see how things play out in the future.

Q5 Currently WD has R&D centres in the U.S. and Poland? Are you looking at expanding that map to India?

Rich Rutledge: Our largest R&D sites are in California and we also have sites in Colorado and Oklahoma in the US. Our second largest site is in Malaysia, where our Asia engineering team works. We also have operations in Taiwan and we have relationships, both direct and contractual in Poland. We tend to go where the talent is for the task required but with respect to India, that's a business decision we'll have to discuss at a later date. **Q6**



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